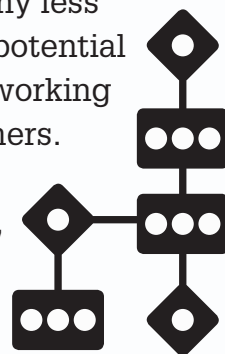




SYSTEMS ANALYST

JOB DESCRIPTION

Information Technology (IT) lies at the heart of most businesses and organizations, so a poorly designed computer system can make a company less efficient. Systems analysts identify potential problems in a computer system by working closely with its users and programmers. They provide recommendations for how the system may be redesigned, and plan and manage ways of achieving these goals.



SALARY

Junior systems analyst ★★★★★

Senior systems analyst ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Healthy jobs market • Employers range from large corporations to small enterprises • Growth in employment in the public and financial services sectors

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Information Technology (IT) • Computer science • Business information technology • Electronic engineering • Mathematics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in a computing-based subject is required. A graduate qualification in business administration is becoming desirable.



LIFESTYLE Systems analysts usually work regular hours, but they may have to work overtime to meet project deadlines.



LOCATION Work is usually office-based, but sometimes projects can be done remotely from home. Travel to visit clients may be required.



THE REALITIES The fast-paced nature of work and tight deadlines can be stressful. Systems analysts need to keep up to date with fast-evolving technology.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **SOFTWARE ENGINEER** *see pp. 118–119*
- ▶ **DATABASE ADMINISTRATOR** *see pp. 122–123*
- ▶ **NETWORK ENGINEER** *see pp. 124–125*
- ▶ **DATA ANALYST** Analyzes the huge volume of computer data companies collect to identify patterns that may help make a business more profitable. Data analysts then present these findings to senior management.
- ▶ **IT RISK MANAGER** Scrutinizes a company's IT systems, and identifies and fixes security weaknesses that could lead to the theft or damage of computer-based information.

In its list of “Best Jobs in 2014,” *US News and World Report* listed systems analyst at No. 2.

